DISCOVER DEKALB
GEORGIA

# SIP STATION

## LOCAL PRODUCT INTEGRATION GUIDE

Seasonal beverages crafted with DeKalb makers, community partners and Georgia-grown ingredients.



POWERED BY TRAILBLAZERS

Fresh sips. Local stories. Bright futures.

LOCAL SOURCING FRAMEWORK

# Make the DeKalb connection clear in every cup

The strongest approach is not to claim that every ingredient is grown in DeKalb. Instead, each signature beverage should feature at least one ingredient that is grown, roasted, blended, produced or prepared by a DeKalb County partner.

**CRAFTED IN DEKALB WITH INGREDIENTS FROM DEKALB MAKERS AND GEORGIA FARMS**

## THREE LEVELS OF LOCAL INCLUSION

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | DEKALB-MADE | Coffee roasted locally, locally blended teas, local honey, or syrups and purees prepared by Trailblazers in a DeKalb kitchen. |
| 2 | DEKALB-PARTNERED | Recipes co-developed with DeKalb coffee shops, growers, immigrant-owned businesses, chefs and community organizations. |
| 3 | GEORGIA-GROWN | Seasonal peaches, blueberries, strawberries, apples and herbs purchased from Georgia growers through producer-led markets. |

## POTENTIAL LOCAL PARTNERS

| PARTNER | POTENTIAL SIP STATION ROLE |
|---|---|
| **Global Growers Network** | Seasonal mint, basil, lemongrass, cucumbers and culturally significant herbs; farm and food-system storytelling. |
| **Radio Roasters - Decatur** | Locally roasted coffee for the fall and winter menu, including hot coffee, cold brew and espresso-based concepts. |
| **Stone Mountain Coffee Roasters** | Small-batch coffee, teas, chai and selected Georgia specialty products for year-round beverage development. |
| **Refuge Coffee - Clarkston** | Barista training, guest beverage collaboration and shared workforce-development storytelling. |
| **Decatur Farmers Market** | A pathway to Georgia fruit, herbs, honey and other producer-made ingredients through a producer-led market. |

SPRING + SUMMER

# Fresh-made lemonade and refreshers

Every lemonade is prepared to order with fresh lemon juice, filtered water, ice, fresh fruit and measured flavor components. No premixed lemonade dispensers are required.

| BEVERAGE | LOCAL INCLUSION | SERVICE STORY |
|---|---|---|
| **Decatur Garden Lemonade** | DeKalb-grown mint or basil with a local honey syrup. | Bright, herbaceous and made fresh to order. |
| **Stone Mountain Peach Lemonade** | Georgia peach puree with fresh lemon juice. | A familiar Georgia flavor with strong visitor appeal. |
| **Tucker Blueberry Basil Lemonade** | Georgia blueberries and locally grown basil. | Colorful, highly visual and social-media friendly. |
| **Clarkston Hibiscus Berry Refresher** | Hibiscus tea, Georgia berries and a recipe inspired by Clarkston's global community. | A caffeine-free option with a deep ruby color. |
| **DeKalb Cucumber Mint Cooler** | Local cucumber and mint with fresh lemon and filtered water. | A light, low-sweetness hydration option. |

## STUDENT-MADE COMPONENTS

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| 01 | Prepare seasonal fruit purees and infused simple syrups using standardized recipes. |
| 02 | Wash, cut and portion fruit and herbs using approved food-safety procedures. |
| 03 | Measure each beverage to order so flavor, food cost and quality remain consistent. |
| 04 | Track the local vendor, ingredient origin and seasonal availability for every featured drink. |

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| **MADE FRESH TO ORDER** | Fresh lemon + filtered water + ice + fruit + measured house flavor |

FALL + WINTER

# Warm beverages with a DeKalb story

The winter menu can spotlight DeKalb-roasted coffee, tea collaborations, Georgia apples and student-made flavor syrups while maintaining the same permanent Sip Station identity.

| BEVERAGE | LOCAL INCLUSION |
|---|---|
| **Stone Mountain Roast** | Coffee roasted by a Stone Mountain or DeKalb County roasting partner. |
| **Decatur Honey Cinnamon Latte** | DeKalb-roasted coffee with locally sourced honey-cinnamon syrup. |
| **Clarkston Cardamom Chai** | A chai recipe inspired by Clarkston's international community and co-developed with a local business. |
| **Georgia Apple Cider Tea** | Georgia apples or cider with a spice blend prepared by Trailblazers. |
| **Arabia Mountain Mocha** | DeKalb-roasted coffee with chocolate and cinnamon. |
| **Trailblazer Hot Chocolate** | A student-made chocolate base with rotating peppermint, toasted marshmallow or cinnamon flavors. |

## MAKE THE PARTNERSHIP VISIBLE

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| **LOCAL SIP ICON** | Place a small icon beside every beverage containing a DeKalb-made or Georgia-grown component. |
| **FEATURED MAKER** | List the farm, roaster, grower or local business directly beneath the drink description. |
| **QR STORY** | Link customers to a Meet Our Local Makers page with the partner's story and the Trailblazer who helped create the drink. |
| **MONTHLY COLLABORATION** | Rotate one Community Collaboration Sip to feature another DeKalb neighborhood or small business. |

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| **STONE MOUNTAIN PEACH LEMONADE** | Made fresh with Georgia peaches<br>Syrup crafted by Discover DeKalb Trailblazers |

## RECOMMENDED LAUNCH

Launch with four summer beverages and four winter beverages. Require one DeKalb-made or Georgia-grown inclusion in every signature drink, then add one rotating Community Collaboration Sip each month.

IMPLEMENTATION

# From local idea to reliable service

Local sourcing works best when the story is supported by consistent supply, food-safety controls and clear purchasing records.

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|---|---|---|
| 1 | **IDENTIFY** | Create a short list of DeKalb growers, roasters, tea partners, honey producers and culturally rooted food businesses. |
| 2 | **VERIFY** | Confirm wholesale pricing, product origin, seasonality, lead time, delivery options, insurance and production capacity. |
| 3 | **DEVELOP** | Invite selected partners to a tasting where Trailblazers test recipes, portion sizes, sweetness levels and presentation. |
| 4 | **STANDARDIZE** | Create recipe cards with exact measurements, yields, food cost, allergen notes and approved substitutions. |
| 5 | **TELL THE STORY** | Photograph the partner, ingredient and student team for menus, QR content and social media. |
| 6 | **MEASURE** | Track local purchasing dollars, beverages sold, student competencies and customer feedback. |

## SUGGESTED SUCCESS MEASURES

| 100% | 1+ | 1 |
|---|---|---|
| Signature drinks with a documented local inclusion | DeKalb or Georgia partner ingredient in each signature drink | Rotating community collaboration beverage each month |

## SOURCE LINKS

Global Growers Network - https://www.globalgrowers.org/

Radio Roasters - https://www.radioroasters.com/

Stone Mountain Coffee Roasters - https://www.stonemountaincoffee.com/

Refuge Coffee Co. - https://www.refugecoffeeco.com/

Community Farmers Markets - https://cfmatl.org/

**FRESH SIPS. LOCAL STORIES. BRIGHT FUTURES.**